

some preliminary tests. I came to the conclusion that there was a lot of edge in this type of approach.

Out of my sheer excitement in discovering this style of model—an approach that still remains at the core of what I do today—I couldn't wait to do more extensive testing. To speed things up, I was working on two computers. But then the lab got crowded, and I had to give up one. I started thinking, *This place is going to empty out sometime tonight*. I decided to get all my data prepared so that I could simultaneously use many of the lab's computers that night. I was very excited about the idea. People started to leave, and then I had two computers, then four, and eventually I was jumping between 20 computers running my backtests.

Were you testing your system on one market on each computer?

That is exactly what I was doing. I was so excited about the results I was getting that I worked all night and continued through the next day. It was going so well that I pulled a second all-nighter. I worked for nearly 40 hours straight, keeping myself awake with the caffeine from drinking a Pepsi every hour. I was still living on the farm at the time. It was dangerous driving home on the second morning. I remember almost falling asleep at the wheel a couple of times. I got home, took about 3 minutes to tell my father what I had accomplished, and then went to bed. I slept for 24 hours straight. When I woke up, I felt completely refreshed. I remember sometime later reading that you can't catch up on your sleep and thinking, *Not true!*

What did you do next?

I went back to the computer lab and continued cranking, although I didn't pull any more all-nighters.

Did you make any further discoveries?

I discovered that it was much better to use multiple models than a single best model.

Sometime after that week with the two consecutive all-nighters when I had that feeling, "Whoa, I think I've got it," I told my mom, "I know you are really frustrated that I didn't interview for jobs after graduating college, and that instead, I am trying to do this trading thing, which I